Causes	*Conditions*	*Prevention*
(c) Moisture: Moisture makes the skin swollen, unhealthy and easily breakable.	***The following reasons result in moisture over the pressure areas:*** 1) Incontinence of faeces and urine. 2) Severe perspiration. 3) Leaving a patient in wet linen 4) ***Heat:*** Leaving a patient in one position for a long time, the part gets heated. 5) Lack of cleanliness and irritating substances on the skin. Eg.Perspiration, faeces, urine and vaginal discharge.	1) Keep dressings and bed dry and clean. 2) Clean and dry the incontinent patients promptly. 3) If necessary, can use diapers.

5.4.7.2. Preventive measures:

1) Improve patient's health by means of good food, ventilation, sunlight and exercises.
2) Encourage circulation through massage.
3) Have patient to ambulate early.
4) ***Observe early signs and symptoms of decubitus ulcers:*** a) Redness. b) Dark discoloration. c) Bruising. d) Tenderness of the area. e) Burning sensation.
5) Give good care to pressure points: Careful cleaning and massage should be carried out 3 or 4 times a day for all bedridden patients. For some patients, it is necessary to give care as often as every two hours when the position of the patient is changed.

5.4.7.3. Treatment of decubitus ulcer.

1) Clean ulcers with aseptic precautions Use antiseptics such as hydrogen peroxide.
2) Apply medication ordered by the doctor, eg. Antibiotic ointment, shark liver oil, zinc oxide, (or) any other topical applications.
3) Cover with sterile dressings and bandage.
4) Surgical formentation, ultraviolet rays (or) heat lamp are helpful in healing.
5) Provide good nutrition.
6) Prevent secondary infections.

5.4.7.4. Sponging or Bed Bath

Definition: Bathing the patient while he is in the bed.

Purpose:

1) To cleanse the skin and thus increase elimination through it.
2) To stimulate circulation through slightly active (or) entirely passive exercise.
3) To refresh the patient by relieving fatigue and discomfort.

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